

STOP BELIEVING LIES

At the start of this book, we established that we've been lied to about millionaires. And I've just spent several chapters debunking the most common millionaire myths we discovered in our research. Let's do a quick review.

- **MYTH 1: Wealthy People Inherited All Their Money**

TRUTH: 79% of millionaires received zero inheritance, meaning only 21% received any inheritance at all. Only 16% of millionaires inherited more than \$100,000, and only 3% inherited \$1 million or more.

- **MYTH 2: Wealthy People Are Just Lucky**

TRUTH: 76% of millionaires say that anyone in America can become a millionaire with discipline and hard work.

- **MYTH 3: Wealthy People Make Risky Investments**

Truth: 79% of millionaires reached millionaire status through their employer-sponsored retirement plan.

- **MYTH 4: Wealthy People Take Stupid Risks to Get Rich Quick**

TRUTH: The average millionaire hits the \$1 million mark at 49 years old. This is after years—*decades*, in fact—of hard work. Only 5% of millionaires got there in ten years or less.

- **MYTH 5: Wealthy People Have Prestigious Private-School Educations**

TRUTH: 79% of millionaires did not attend prestigious private schools. 62% graduated from public state schools, 8% attended community college, and 9% never graduated college at all.